

Introduction

LeicesterBreaks is a weekend city break website designed to showcase Leicester's unique blend of modern attractions and historical heritage. The motivation behind developing this platform was to create an accessible and intuitive experience that connects hobbyist travellers with Leicester's diverse offerings. Key user requirements that shaped the design include the ability to visually explore Leicester through a customisable gallery experience, access to detailed information about highly rated attractions with visitor reviews, and a streamlined event booking system that simplifies the process of securing places at local events. The result is an engaging, user-friendly platform that makes planning a weekend break cohesive and enjoyable.

Prototype functionality

The LeicesterBreaks prototype implements several features designed to create a comprehensive user experience for weekend city break planning including one common function and three advanced features which were designed as wireframes previously, I have decided to make no design changes from those wireframes.

Common Function: Login/Sign-up

The prototype includes a robust login/sign-up system, which includes:

- An interface allowing users to either log in with existing credentials or create a new account
- Form validation ensuring data integrity (username requirements and minimum 8-character password)
- Local storage integration that remembers usernames and passwords
- Seamless transition to the main homepage upon successful authentication

This feature was implemented to create a personalised experience for users and establish a foundation for potential future features like saved favourites, personalised recommendations, and exclusive deals.

Advanced Feature 1: The Leicester Gallery

The Leicester Gallery implements an eye-catching visual showcase that allows users to explore Leicester through different themes.

- Dynamic filtering between three distinct categories: The City, The Countryside, and Leicester Exclusive
- Smooth, automatic slideshow transitions
- Manual navigation controls (previous/next arrows and clickable navigation dots)

This feature is significant in the development of my website, as these images can help users quickly focus on aspects of Leicester that align with their interests, making the initial discovery process more engaging.

Advanced Feature 2: Leicester Attractions (Review system)

The Leicester Attractions section delivers information about Leicester's best attractions while implementing a social element through user reviews.

- Card-based overview of three highly rated attractions with a visual preview, rating, and brief description
- Detailed information pages for each attraction
- Structured presentation of practical information (location, contact details, opening hours, facilities, etc.)
- Display of existing visitor reviews with ratings
- Interactive review submission form with a star rating system and validation
- Confirmation feedback upon successful submission

This feature combines informative details with other people's experiences in the form of reviews, allowing users to grasp a complete understanding of what to expect.

Advanced Feature 3: Events in Leicester (Booking system)

The Events in Leicester section provides a streamlined process for discovering and securing places for the best events in Leicester.

- Visually appealing event cards displaying key information (name, location, date, time, description, price)
- User-friendly booking interface that includes all necessary input fields.
- Multi-step form with comprehensive validation

This feature was implemented because allowing users to book directly through our website keeps them coming back.

Background technologies

The following background technologies were employed:

CSS:

- Custom CSS styling with responsive design principles
- CSS animations and transitions for interactive elements
- Media queries for device responsiveness across various screen sizes
- CSS variables for consistent colour theming throughout the application

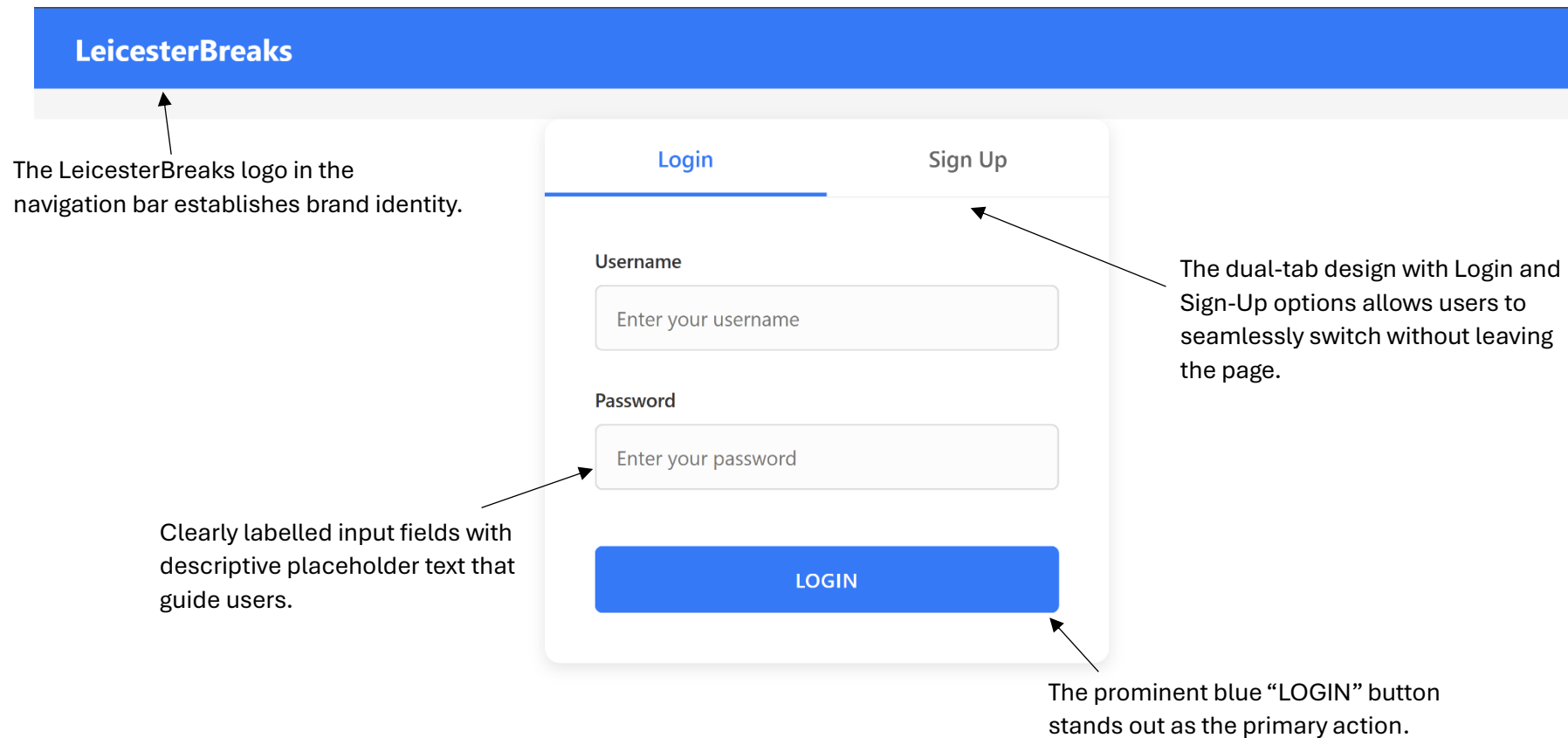
JavaScript Libraries:

- JavaScript for DOM manipulation and event handling
- localStorage API for client-side data saves like username and passwords.
- No external JavaScript libraries were used, allowing for fast loading and execution

Walkthroughs in the Form of Annotated Screenshots

Login/Sign-up

This page provides an entry point into LeicesterBreaks while maintaining a clean, easy-to-use interface with strong validation for enhanced security.



The password field states the minimum character requirement (8+ characters).

Login

Sign Up

Username

Choose a username

Password

Create a password (8+ characters)

SIGN UP

The input fields display placeholder text that provides guidance to users for account creation.

The primary button text changes to "SIGN UP" to match the current context.



Registration successful! Please login.

The message "Registration successful! Please login." gives users a clear next step to follow.

Navigation

- Once they have created the account, they will be automatically directed to the login tab
- Successful authentication from the login tab directs users to the home page

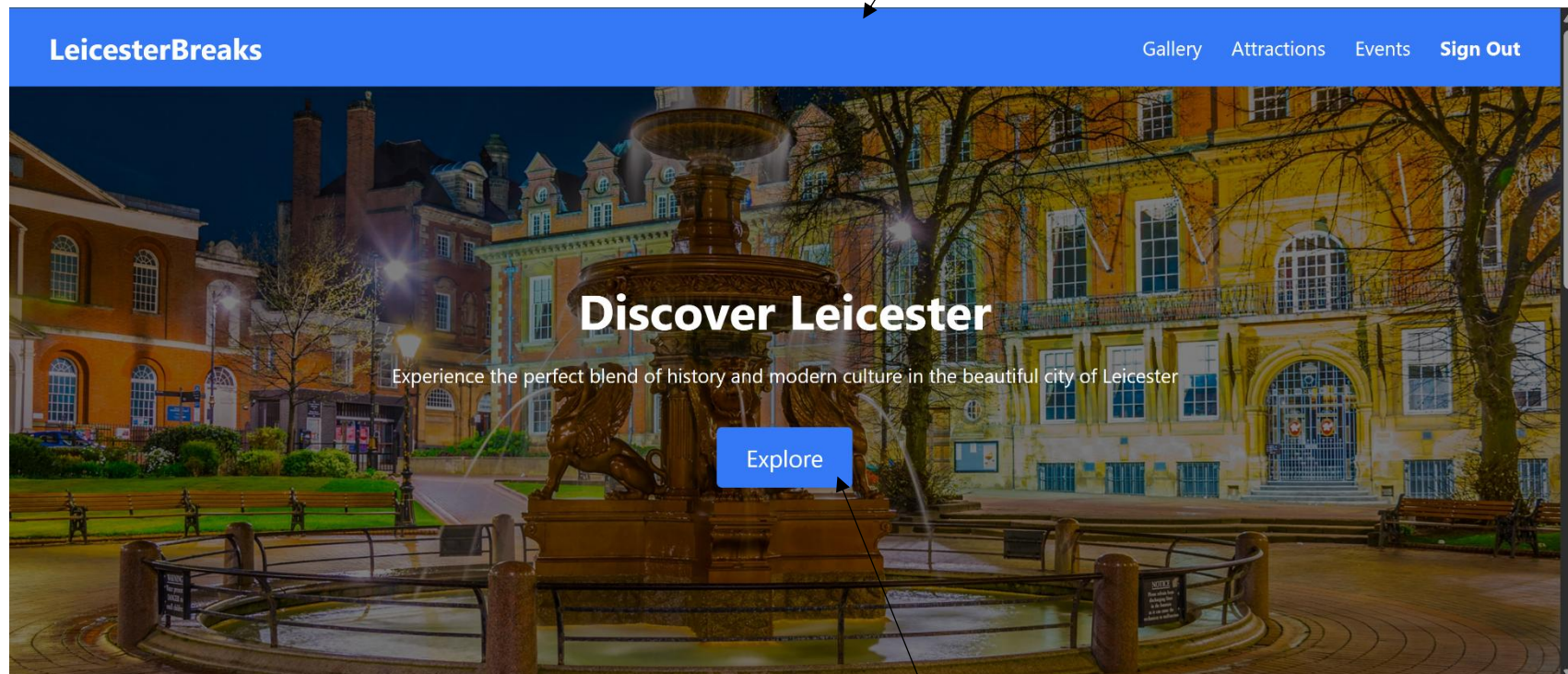
Accessibility

- High contrast between text and background throughout the page enhances readability
- Descriptive labels on form fields support screen readers

Home page

The home page serves as the central hub of LeicesterBreaks, presenting an introduction to the city while providing clear pathways to the platform's key features.

The persistent blue header contains the LeicesterBreaks logo and main navigation links.



An eye-catching background image of a Leicester landmark creates an impactful first impression and grabs the user's attention.

The "Explore" button encourages immediate engagement and directs users to the content sections below.

Each card contains a relevant image that allow users to get a preview and encourage them to interact with the cards.

LeicesterBreaks[Gallery](#)[Attractions](#)[Events](#)[Sign Out](#)

Plan Your Dream Leicester Vacation



Leicester Gallery

View the beauty and culture of the city through the Leicester Gallery

[View Gallery](#)



Leicester Attractions

Discover the best attractions in Leicester that you simply can't miss!

[See Attractions](#)



Events in Leicester

Browse and book exciting events happening in Leicester during your stay

[Find Events](#)

Three visually consistent cards represent the main sections of the website (Gallery, Attractions, Events).

Each card includes a unique call-to-action button with related text.

Brief explanatory text provides context about what users will find in each section.

Navigation

- The navigation bar provides direct access to all main sections (Gallery, Attractions, Events)
- The "Sign Out" link allows users to end their session and return to the login/sign-up page.
- The LeicesterBreaks logo functions as a home link from any page
- The "Explore" button in the hero section smoothly scrolls users to the feature cards below
- Individual feature cards contain direct links to their detailed sections.

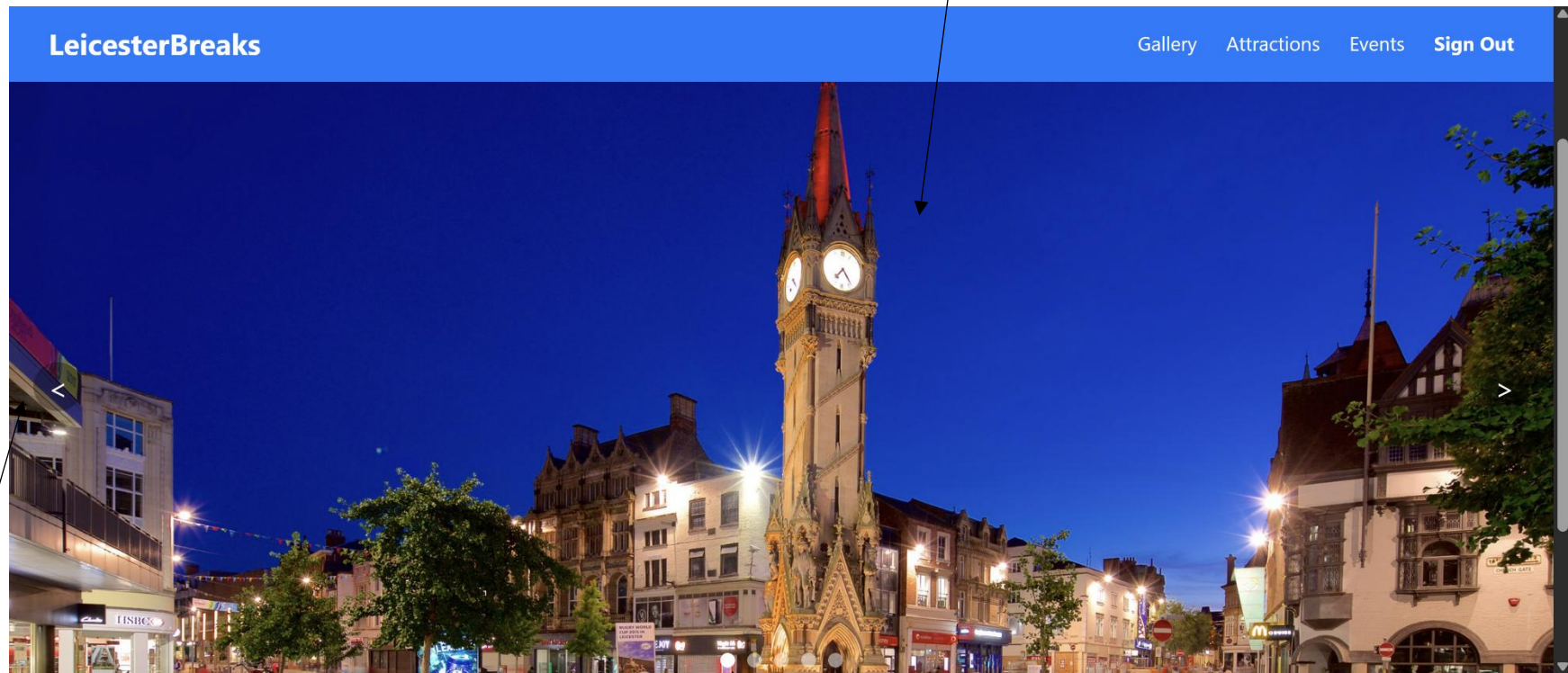
Accessibility

- High contrast between text and background throughout the page enhances readability
- Smooth scrolling behaviour provides visual continuity for users with cognitive disabilities

The Leicester Gallery

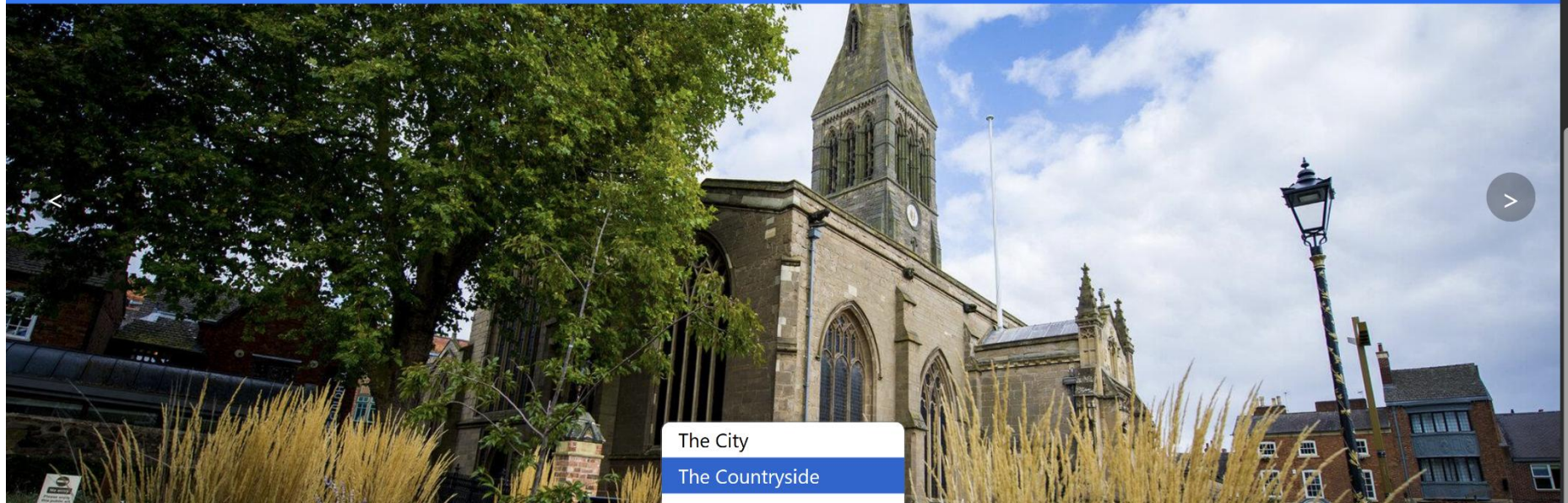
The Leicester Gallery page provides a visual showcase of the city through a filterable slideshow, allowing users to explore different aspects of Leicester.

A immersive image display makes photography the focal point of this section.



Left and right arrows allow users to manually browse through images at their own pace.

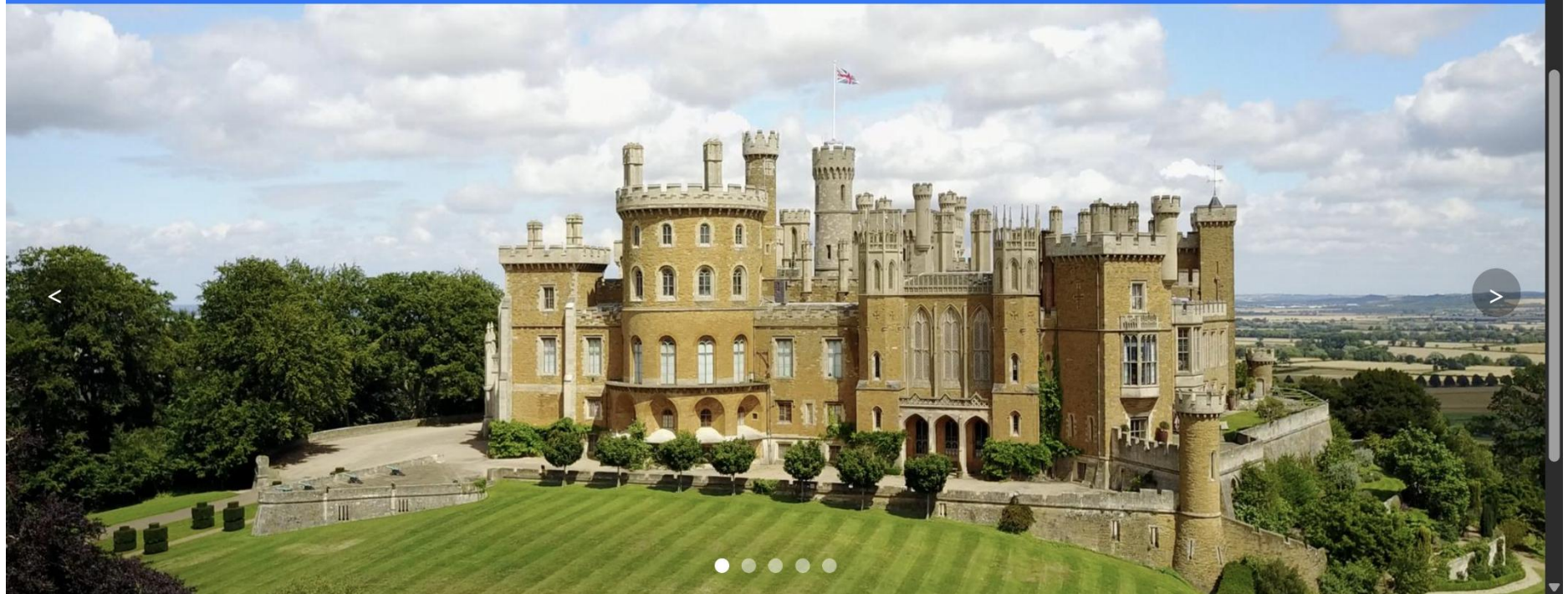
Dots at the bottom of the slideshow indicate the current position and overall number of images in that category.



The City
The Countryside
Leicester Exclusive

The City

A dropdown menu enables users to filter images by three distinct categories: The City, The Countryside, and Leicester Exclusive.



The image changes to showcase images from The Countryside category after they selected it from the dropdown list.

Navigation

- The consistent navigation bar provides easy access to other main sections (Attractions, Events)
- The LeicesterBreaks logo functions as a home page link
- Left and right arrow navigation controls enable movement between images within the current category
- The category filter dropdown allows users to switch between different themed collections
- Navigation dots at the bottom provide a visual indicator of position and allow direct jumping to images.

Accessibility

- High contrast between text and background throughout the page enhances readability
- Consistent placement of navigation elements creates predictability for users with cognitive disabilities

Leicester Attractions

The Attractions page showcases Leicester's most highly-rated destinations, providing users with a selection of amazing experiences to explore during their stay.

LeicesterBreaks

Gallery Attractions Events Sign Out

1. National Space Centre

★★★★★



UK's leading space science centre with interactive exhibits and the iconic Rocket Tower

View Details

2. King Richard III Visitor Centre

★★★★★



Fascinating exhibition telling the story of King Richard III's life, death, and remarkable discovery

View Details

3. Bradgate Park

★★★★★



Beautiful landscape with historic ruins, wildlife, and stunning panoramic views

View Details

Five-star ratings provide immediate quality indicators for each attraction.

Each card includes a "View Details" button that invites users to explore more about the attraction.

Three cards present Leicester's highest-rated attractions in a clean, organized layout.

Each card features an image that shows a preview of what the attraction has to offer.

Brief descriptions highlight the key aspects and unique selling points of each attraction.

National Space Centre



Exploration Drive, Leicester LE4 5NS
0116 261 0261

The five-star rating is maintained from the overview page for consistency.

Complete address details and direct phone contact provided for the user.

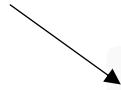
A large photograph showcases the attraction's unique environment.

Comprehensive paragraph provides context about the attraction and its features.



The National Space Centre is the UK's largest visitor attraction dedicated to space exploration and space science. This award-winning attraction combines interactive exhibits, authentic space artifacts, and the iconic 42m high Rocket Tower to create an out-of-this-world experience for visitors of all ages.

Properly structured into clear categories
(Opening Hours, Highlights, Facilities,
Website).



Opening Hours

Monday - Sunday: 10:00 - 16:00

Highlights

UK's Largest Planetarium
42m Rocket Tower
Interactive Galleries
Space Mission Simulators

Facilities

Café & Restaurant
Gift Shop
Over 400 parking spaces
Disabled Access

Website

www.spacecentre.co.uk



A clickable link to the official website
provides access to additional information.



Reviews

Sarah



Amazing experience for the whole family. The rocket tower was breathtaking and the planetarium show was out of this world. Highly recommended for anyone interested in space and science.

Rachel



One of the best science centers I've visited. Interesting exhibits, knowledgeable staff, and plenty to see and do. Plan to spend the whole day here to make the most of it.

Each review includes the reviewer's name.

Detailed review descriptions provide authentic visitor experiences.

Star ratings for each review clearly shows how the visitor rated the attraction.



Add Your Review

Your Name

Rating



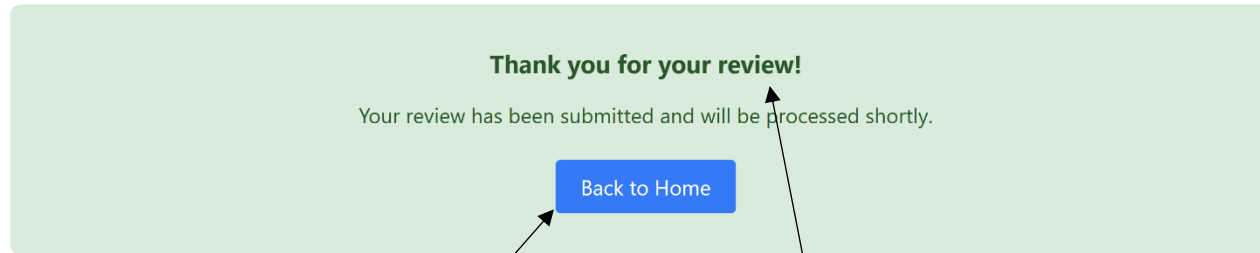
Your Review

Submit Review

Interactive star rating system allows users to provide a rating from one to five stars to show how much they liked/disliked the attraction.

Prominent submit button provides a clear completion action.

Structured fields collect necessary information (name, rating, review description).



"Back to Home" button provides users with the next step, keeping them engaged on the website.

Clear "Thank you" message confirms the review has been received.

Navigation

- The consistent navigation bar allows movement between main sections from any page
- "View Details" buttons on attraction cards link to their respective detailed pages
- The "Back to Home" button after review submission provides a clear return path
- The website link in the details section allows users to visit the official attraction website for additional information
- Users can move from browsing attractions to submitting reviews within the same coherent flow
- The form submission process guides users through a clear sequence with confirmation

Accessibility

- High contrast between text and background throughout the page enhances readability
- Information is organized in a logical, hierarchical structure that supports screen reader navigation
- The "Disabled Access" note in facilities provides important accessibility information for visitors
- Interactive elements like buttons and star ratings have adequate size for enhanced readability

Events in Leicester

The Event in Leicester section showcases upcoming activities and experiences in Leicester, allowing users to discover and book events during their stay in the city.

LeicesterBreaks[Gallery](#)[Attractions](#)[Events](#)[Sign Out](#)



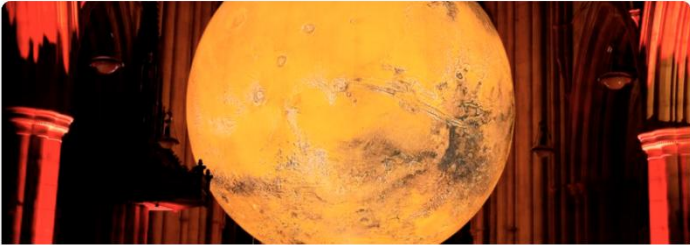
Destination Dining

National Space Centre, Leicester
17th May 2025
19:00 - 23:30

Celebrate Apollo 10 with the exclusive Destination Dining event. Enjoy a gourmet three-course meal, and a guided tour of the night sky in the UK's largest planetarium. A perfect blend of science, history, and culinary artistry.

£69.00

[Book](#)



Family Fun under Mars

Leicester Cathedral, Leicester
26th May 2025
16:30 - 19:30

Experience an unforgettable evening beneath the stunning Mars sculpture at the Leicester Cathedral. Take part in an interactive activity trail and enjoy a rare opportunity to explore the Cathedral after hours, immersing yourself in its history and architecture.

£5.00

[Book](#)

High-quality images give a visual preview of each experience.

Clear event name, venue location, date and timings are provided for the user.

"Book" button provides access to a form that allows users to book directly on the website.

Displays costs clearly.

Clean, structured cards present upcoming events in a visually appealing format.

Date and price information is maintained in the header for reference.

Clear title indicates both the action which is 'Book' and the event being booked.

Allows users to exit the booking process if they would like.

The image shows a web interface for 'LeicesterBreaks'. A modal form titled 'Book: Destination Dining' is overlaid on a page for 'Destination Dining'. The modal contains a header with the event name, date, and price, followed by input fields for personal details and a ticket selection dropdown. The background page shows event details and a 'Book' button.

LeicesterBreaks

Book: Destination Dining X

17th May 2025
£69.00

First Name * **Last Name ***

Email Address * **Phone Number ***

Number of Tickets *

Select number of tickets ▼

Gallery Attractions Events **Sign Out**

Destination Dining

National Space Centre, Leicester

17th May 2025

19:00 - 23:30

Celebrate Apollo 10 with the exclusive D...
gourmet three-course meal, and a guide...
UK's largest planetarium. A perfect blend...
artistry.

£69.00

ing beneath the stunning Mars
al. Take part in an interactive activity
to explore the Cathedral after hours,
nd architecture.

Book

Asterisks (*) mark required information fields.

The screenshot shows a booking form for 'LeicesterBreaks'. The form is titled 'Destination Dining' and includes details about the event: 'National Space Centre, Leicester', '17th May 2025', and '19:00 - 23:30'. The price is listed as '£69.00'. The form fields include 'Email Address*', 'Phone Number*', 'Number of Tickets*' (a dropdown menu), and 'Additional Requirements' (a text area). A blue 'Complete Booking' button is at the bottom. Annotations with arrows point to the form's scrollability, the 'Additional Requirements' field, the 'Complete Booking' button, and the 'Number of Tickets' dropdown menu.

LeicesterBreaks

Gallery Attractions Events Sign Out

Destination Dining

National Space Centre, Leicester
17th May 2025
19:00 - 23:30

Celebrate Apollo 10 with the exclusive Destination Dining gourmet three-course meal, and a guided tour of the UK's largest planetarium. A perfect blend of science and artistry.

£69.00

Book

Email Address*

Phone Number*

Number of Tickets*

Select number of tickets

Additional Requirements

Disabilities, allergies, dietary requirements, etc.

Complete Booking

The form scrolls to reveal additional fields as the user completes the booking process.

The "Additional Requirements" field allows users to share accessibility needs.

The "Complete Booking" button clearly indicates the completion action.

A dropdown menu for selecting the number of tickets provides a controlled input method. The image below shows the dropdown list:

Number of Tickets*

Select number of tickets

Select number of tickets

1

2

3

4

5

Destination Dining

National Space Centre, Leicester

17th May 2025

19:00 - 23:30

Celebrate Apollo 10 with the exclusive D...
gourmet three-course meal, and a guide...
UK's largest planetarium. A perfect blend...
artistry.

£69.00

Book

£5.00

Book

Booking confirmed!

Thank you for booking with LeicesterBreaks.

Close

The "Close" button provides a clear way to dismiss the confirmation and return to browsing.

The green "Booking confirmed!" heading clearly communicates the successful outcome.

Navigation

- Each event card's "Book" button initiates the booking process for that selected event
- The booking form design keeps users within the context of the Events page rather than redirecting them
- The close button in the booking form allows users to cancel and return to browsing
- The form structure guides users through the booking process in a logical order
- The "Close" button on the confirmation screen closes the booking form.

Accessibility

- High contrast between text and background throughout the page enhances readability
- The "Additional Requirements" field explicitly provides space for accessibility needs and preferences

Heuristic Evaluation and Usability Testing Results

Heuristic Evaluation

The heuristic evaluation process was conducted using Nielsen's 10 usability heuristics. In order to evaluate the LeicesterBreaks prototype effectively, I developed a structured heuristic evaluation form that allowed participants to assess each heuristic, document observations, identify issues, and assign severity ratings on a scale from 0 (not a problem) to 4 (usability catastrophe). This form was sent to five "end-users", the results can be seen below:

1.

LeicesterBreaks Heuristic Evaluation Form

Experience with travel websites in the past (1-5): 4

1. Visibility of System Status

Write your observations here: I liked the confirmation messages when submitting reviews and completing bookings. The blue highlighting on the selected gallery category was helpful.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): There are no loading symbols or indicators anywhere in this website.

Severity Rating (0-4): 1

2. Match Between System and the Real World

Write your observations here: The language used throughout the site is clear and straightforward.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

3. Consistency and Standards

Write your observations here: The blue navigation bar remains consistent across all pages, making it easy to navigate. Button styles are also consistent.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

4. User Control and Freedom

Write your observations here: The event booking have clear exit options. The navigation bar is always available to return to other sections.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): When filling out the review form, there should be an option to clear your response.

Severity Rating (0-4): 2

5. Error Prevention

Write your observations here: The required fields are marked with asterisks therefore prevents submission if required fields are empty.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): There's no confirmation step before submitting a review or booking, making it easy to submit accidentally.

Severity Rating (0-4): 2

6. Recognition Rather Than Recall

Write your observations here: Navigation options are always visible. The gallery filtering options are clearly displayed.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

7. Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Write your observations here: The site layout is straightforward and easy to navigate.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

8. Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Write your observations here: Clean design with appropriate spacing and high-quality images.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

9. Ability to identify and recover from errors

Write your observations here: Form validation provides clear feedback when something is missing.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): Error messages could include better detail

Severity Rating (0-4): 1

10. Help and Documentation

Write your observations here: Address, contact information and external website links are available.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): No FAQ section or help section

Severity Rating (0-4): 3

Overall Assessment

What aspects of the website worked well? (Write below) The gallery filtering feature worked smoothly. The attraction detail pages provided comprehensive information in a well-organized format.

What were the most significant issues? (Write below) A simple FAQ or help section would improve user confidence, especially for the booking process.

Additional suggestions: (Write below) Adding a confirmation step before final submission of reviews and bookings would prevent accidental submissions.

2.

LeicesterBreaks Heuristic Evaluation Form

Experience with travel websites in the past (1-5): 5

1. Visibility of System Status

Write your observations here: The gallery shows which category you're looking at. Liked the green confirmation message after booking.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

2. Match Between System and the Real World

Write your observations here: Everything made sense to me. Easy to understand the labels.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

3. Consistency and Standards

Write your observations here: Site looks the same throughout. Buttons are similar on all pages.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

4. User Control and Freedom

Write your observations here: I was able to exit the booking popup easily with the X button.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

5. Error Prevention

Write your observations here: Forms show what's required. Password needs 8+ characters.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

6. Recognition Rather Than Recall

Write your observations here: When exploring, I did not have to remember things, options were visible.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): The gallery filters reset when you go back to them.

Severity Rating (0-4): 2

7. Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Write your observations here: Simple to use.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): No search box to find attractions.

Severity Rating (0-4): 2

8. Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Write your observations here: Liked the clean look. Not cluttered with too much stuff.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

9. Ability to identify and recover from errors

Write your observations here: Red highlights show when something's wrong in forms.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

10. Help and Documentation

Write your observations here: Not really much going for help and documentation in this website.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): No help or FAQ section anywhere.

Severity Rating (0-4): 4

Overall Assessment

What aspects of the website worked well? (Write below) The attractions pages was nice with all the details and pictures. Easy to sign up. Booking was simple.

What were the most significant issues? (Write below) No help section if users get stuck.

Additional suggestions: (Write below) Make the gallery remember your last filter choice.

3.

LeicesterBreaks Heuristic Evaluation Form

Experience with travel websites in the past (1-5): 5

1. Visibility of System Status

Write your observations here: The website provides appropriate feedback. I particularly appreciated the visual confirmation after completing a booking and submitting reviews. The gallery's category selection indicates the current selection through colour highlighting, which is effective.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

2. Match Between System and the Real World

Write your observations here: The Navigation labels are descriptively named and organized logically.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

3. Consistency and Standards

Write your observations here: Overall consistency is strong. UI elements maintain styling, and the navigation structure remains stable throughout the experience.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

4. User Control and Freedom

Write your observations here: The booking forms include appropriate exits. Navigation between main sections is straightforward.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): The website would benefit with a clear button when filling in the forms with information.

Severity Rating (0-4): 2

5. Error Prevention

Write your observations here: Form validation is implemented effectively for required fields. Password requirements are stated upfront.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

6. Recognition Rather Than Recall

Write your observations here: The site generally excels at making options visible.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

7. Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Write your observations here: The interface caters well to new users with its straightforward design.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): Lacks efficiency enhancements for repeat visitors. A search function and favourites/bookmarking capability would improve efficiency.

Severity Rating (0-4): 2

8. Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Write your observations here: The design strikes an excellent balance between visual appeal and functional simplicity. Content is relevant and well-organized.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

9. Ability to identify and recover from errors

Write your observations here: Form validation provides immediate feedback when errors occur. Error states are visually distinct.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): Error messages could be more detailed about resolution steps, particularly in the login process.

Severity Rating (0-4): 1

10. Help and Documentation

Write your observations here: Almost no help is available.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): The site lacks contextual help, tooltips, or a dedicated FAQ section. This is particularly noticeable when using interactive elements like the booking system.

Severity Rating (0-4): 3

Overall Assessment

What aspects of the website worked well? (Write below) The attraction detail pages are exceptionally well-designed, with comprehensive information.

What were the most significant issues? (Write below) The absence of help documentation presents the most significant usability concern.

Additional suggestions: (Write below) Implementing a favourites feature would enhance this website.

4.

LeicesterBreaks Heuristic Evaluation Form

Experience with travel websites in the past (1-5): 4

1. Visibility of System Status

Write your observations here: Success messages are clear. Navigation shows current page.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): No loading indicators during form submission.

Severity Rating (0-4): 1

2. Match Between System and the Real World

Write your observations here: Good use of familiar tourism terms. Layout follows standard patterns.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

3. Consistency and Standards

Write your observations here: UI is consistent. Header persists across pages.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

4. User Control and Freedom

Write your observations here: The website had great flow, no user restrictions, felt full control.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

5. Error Prevention

Write your observations here: Form validation is implemented well.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

6. Recognition Rather Than Recall

Write your observations here: All options visible in navigation. Categories clearly labelled.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

7. Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Write your observations here: Interface is easy to use and has clear options.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): No shortcuts to minimise time consumption.

Severity Rating (0-4): 2

8. Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Write your observations here: Clean visual hierarchy and colour scheme is cohesive.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

9. Ability to identify and recover from errors

Write your observations here: Form errors are visually highlighted.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

10. Help and Documentation

Write your observations here: Contact info is available for attractions

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): No way of getting, no company email, no chatbot, really nothing.

Severity Rating (0-4): 3

Overall Assessment

What aspects of the website worked well? (Write below) Strong visual design. Attraction and events pages well organized.

What were the most significant issues? (Write below) Needs improvement in Help and Documentation.

Additional suggestions: (Write below) Consider shortcuts.

5.

LeicesterBreaks Heuristic Evaluation Form

Experience with travel websites in the past (1-5): 4

1. Visibility of System Status

Write your observations here: The site gives good feedback after actions like submitting reviews and bookings.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): When switching between gallery categories, there's no indication that it's loading.

Severity Rating (0-4): 1

2. Match Between System and the Real World

Write your observations here: Website uses familiar tourism concepts. The attraction ratings with stars is intuitive.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

3. Consistency and Standards

Write your observations here: The blue theme is consistent throughout. Navigation stays in the same place on all pages.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

4. User Control and Freedom

Write your observations here: The X button to close popups is helpful. Can easily go back to main sections.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): No way to save a partially completed booking for later.

Severity Rating (0-4): 2

5. Error Prevention

Write your observations here: Required fields marked clearly. Password requirements shown upfront.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): When entering a phone number there is no check for a proper phone number format.

Severity Rating (0-4): 3

6. Recognition Rather Than Recall

Write your observations here: All main options visible in the menu. Gallery categories are always shown.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

7. Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Write your observations here: Simple enough for first-time users to navigate.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): No way to filter attractions by type or location. Would help returning users.

Severity Rating (0-4): 2

8. Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Write your observations here: Clean design that focuses on important content. Good use of images.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): N/A

Severity Rating (0-4): 0

9. Ability to identify and recover from errors

Write your observations here: Form validation shows when fields are incorrect.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): The login error message doesn't specify if the username or password was incorrect.

Severity Rating (0-4): 2

10. Help and Documentation

Write your observations here: Contact details are provided for each attraction.

Write down issues (if there are no issues please write 'N/A'): There is contact directly to LeicesterBreaks.

Severity Rating (0-4): 3

Overall Assessment

What aspects of the website worked well? (Write below) The review system for attractions is well implemented. I like how the navigation is simple and consistent.

What were the most significant issues? (Write below) The website needs to check for proper formats in the booking form.

Additional suggestions: (Write below) No additional suggestions.

Usability Testing

I then conducted usability tests with five participants for the LeicesterBreaks prototype. For this assessment, I developed a test form with five tasks designed to evaluate the core functionality of the website which were creating an account, using the gallery feature, finding attraction information, submitting a review, and booking an event. Additionally, I documented success rates (Yes/No/Partially) and gathered post-test feedback. The five results can be viewed below:

1.

LeicesterBreaks Usability Test

Tasks

Task 1: Create an Account

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Completed without issues. Understood password requirements right away.

Task 2: Use the Gallery Feature

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Found the gallery section quickly. Took a moment to notice the category dropdown but figured it out.

Task 3: Find Attraction Information

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Navigated to attractions, found National Space Centre, and identified Saturday opening hours which are 10am-5pm.

Task 4: Submit a Review

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Left a 5-star review for the National Space Centre.

Task 5: Event Booking

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Booked the Supercars Fest event.

Post-Test Questions

1. **What was the easiest task to complete? Why?** Finding attraction information was easiest because the details were well organized and clearly labelled.
2. **What was the most difficult task to complete? Why?** Nothing stood out as difficult
3. **On a scale of 1-5, how easy was the website to use overall?** 5
4. **Would you use this website to plan a trip to Leicester?** Yes
5. **Any other comments or suggestions?** No

2.

LeicesterBreaks Usability Test

Tasks

Task 1: Create an Account

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Easy login and account creation.

Task 2: Use the Gallery Feature

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Quickly found gallery and found countryside images including parks.

Task 3: Find Attraction Information

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Found National Space Centre opening hours without difficulty.

Task 4: Submit a Review

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Review completed; however, it would be better if the reviewer's name was just my username.

Task 5: Event Booking

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Booked one event and 1 ticket ordered, the booking confirmation has no detail.

Post-Test Questions

1. **What was the easiest task to complete? Why?** Using the gallery was easiest because the images loaded quickly and categories were easy to switch between.
2. **What was the most difficult task to complete? Why?** Not necessarily a difficult task but I feel as if there is no detail in the confirmation when booking making it hard for users to understand where to look for their tickets.
3. **On a scale of 1-5, how easy was the website to use overall?** 4
4. **Would you use this website to plan a trip to Leicester?** Yes
5. **Any other comments or suggestions?** Make review name, the username of the accounts.

3.

LeicesterBreaks Usability Test

Tasks

Task 1: Create an Account

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Completed smoothly and liked the simplicity.

Task 2: Use the Gallery Feature

- Success: Partially
- Notes: At first, did not realise there was a filter as it was at the bottom.

Task 3: Find Attraction Information

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Located information quickly.

Task 4: Submit a Review

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Submitted a 5-star review for Bradgate Park without issues.

Task 5: Event Booking

- Success: Yes
- Notes: I decided to book two events to see if it worked, and it worked with no issue.

Post-Test Questions

1. **What was the easiest task to complete? Why?** Finding attraction information was simplest because the layout is logical and the details are well organized.
2. **What was the most difficult task to complete? Why?** The gallery task was a bit challenging because I didn't realise there was a filter until you scroll down.
3. **On a scale of 1-5, how easy was the website to use overall?** 4
4. **Would you use this website to plan a trip to Leicester?** Yes
5. **Any other comments or suggestions?** It might be helpful to put the gallery filter at the start.

4.

LeicesterBreaks Usability Test

Tasks

Task 1: Create an Account

- Success: Yes
- Notes: No problems

Task 2: Use the Gallery Feature

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Found parks but did not like the fact that the images moved on their own.

Task 3: Find Attraction Information

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Navigated directly to national space centre and found the opening hours without difficulty.

Task 4: Submit a Review

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Left a review for King Richard III Visitor Centre, no problems.

Task 5: Event Booking

- Success: Yes
- Notes: No issues.

Post-Test Questions

1. **What was the easiest task to complete? Why?** Finding information was easy.
2. **What was the most difficult task to complete? Why?** No difficulties.
3. **On a scale of 1-5, how easy was the website to use overall?** 5
4. **Would you use this website to plan a trip to Leicester?** Yes
5. **Any other comments or suggestions?** No automatic slideshow.

5.

LeicesterBreaks Usability Test

Tasks

Task 1: Create an Account

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Completed quickly without issues.

Task 2: Use the Gallery Feature

- Success: Yes
- Notes: High quality images and found parks in countryside filter

Task 3: Find Attraction Information

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Found opening hours easily

Task 4: Submit a Review

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Star rating animations was clean, and the review format was great.

Task 5: Event Booking

- Success: Yes
- Notes: Good booking form, with option to exit.

Post-Test Questions

1. **What was the easiest task to complete? Why?** Booking was really easy.
2. **What was the most difficult task to complete? Why?** N/A
3. **On a scale of 1-5, how easy was the website to use overall?** 5
4. **Would you use this website to plan a trip to Leicester?** Yes
5. **Any other comments or suggestions?** N/A

Feedback and Discussion

Heuristic Evaluation Findings

The heuristic evaluation revealed several consistent patterns across the five feedback results. The primary strengths identified were the aesthetic design, system-world match, and consistency of the interface. All testers rated these aspects of my website with minimal severity scores, indicating strong implementation of these usability principles. However, the tests revealed that they were also several significant areas for improvement

Help and Documentation

All five evaluators identified the lack of help and documentation as a significant issue, with severity ratings ranging from 3-4. As one participant clearly stated, "No FAQ section or help section."

If the LeicesterBreaks prototype were to be developed into a full product, I would implement a dedicated help section. This would include frequently asked questions organized by feature, step-by-step guides for complex processes like booking and reviewing.

Error Prevention

Some testers highlighted issues with insufficient confirmation steps before taking important actions. One participant mentioned, "There's no confirmation step before submitting a review or booking, making it easy to submit accidentally."

Furthermore, another participant noted a issue with validation as they stated, "When entering a phone number there is no check for a proper phone number format," giving this issue a severity rating of 3.

In future iterations, I would enhance error prevention by implementing confirmation messages for all critical actions including review submissions, event bookings, and account sign-out. Additionally, I would improve form validation by including a phone number format check, preventing false inputs.

User Control and Freedom

Three evaluators identified issues with form controls in their assessments. One participant noted, "When filling out the review form, there should be an option to clear your response," assigning a severity rating of 2.

Another stated, "No way to save a partially completed booking for later," also with a severity rating of 2.

In future development, I would add clear/reset buttons to all forms and implement a save for later function for multi-step processes like booking. These improvements would enhance user control, allowing people to recover from mistakes and complete tasks at their own pace, which aligns with Nielsen's heuristic principles.

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Four evaluators identified limitations in this area, with severity ratings of 2. One participant stated, "Lacks efficiency enhancements for repeat visitors. A search function and favourites/bookmarking capability would improve efficiency."

To address these concerns, future development would implement a search function, filtering options for attractions, and personalized features that remember user preferences. These enhancements would create a more efficient experience, particularly for returning users.

Recognition Rather Than Recall

One evaluator identified an issue in the gallery, with a severity rating of 2. The participant noted, "The gallery filters reset when you go back to them,"

In the next iteration, I would maintain filter selections when navigating between pages. This would reduce the need for users to remember their previous actions, improving the overall usability of the site.

Visibility of System Status

Three evaluators identified minor issues with loading indicators, with severity ratings of 1. One participant noted, "There are no loading symbols or indicators anywhere in this website,"

In future development, I would add subtle loading indicators for transitions between pages and during form submissions to keep users informed about ongoing processes. This would provide better feedback about system status which aligns with Nielsen's 10 usability heuristics.

Ability to Identify and Recover from Errors

Three evaluators identified opportunities to improve error messaging as one noted, "Error messages could include better detail,"

In a future iteration, I would enhance error messages to be more detailed about what went wrong and how to fix it, particularly for login failures and form validation errors. This would help users quickly identify and resolve problems without frustration.

Usability Testing Findings

The usability testing offered valuable insights into how real users interact with the LeicesterBreaks prototype when completing key tasks. Overall, the results demonstrated a high degree of success across all tasks, with participants generally finding the interface intuitive and easy to navigate.

Account Creation (100% Success Rate)

All five participants successfully completed the account creation task without significant issues. One participant noted that they "Completed without issues. Understood password requirements right away." The consistent success with this task indicates that the registration process is intuitive and well-designed.

Gallery Feature (90% Success Rate)

Four participants completed this task successfully, while one achieved partial success. The participant with partial success noted, "At first, did not realise there was a filter as it was at the bottom." Additionally, one participant commented that they "did not like the fact that the images moved on their own," highlighting an issue with the automatic slideshow.

In future development, I would relocate the gallery filter to a more prominent position of the page and add controls to pause the automatic slideshow. These changes would address both the discoverability issue and provide users with more control over the image viewing experience.

Finding Attraction Information (100% Success Rate)

This task had perfect completion across all participants and was frequently mentioned as the easiest task to complete. Multiple participants noted how well-organized the attraction information was, with one stating, "Finding attraction information was easiest because the details were well organized and clearly labelled."

Submitting a Review (100% Success Rate)

All participants successfully submitted reviews, though one suggested an improvement as they said, "Review completed; however, it would be better if the reviewer's name was just my username."

For future development, I would consider implementing an option for users to choose between displaying their username or entering a custom name for reviews. This enhancement would provide greater flexibility, therefore enhancing the user experience.

Event Booking (100% Success Rate)

While all participants successfully completed the booking task, one identified a potential improvement, noting that "the booking confirmation has no detail."

In a complete product version, I would enhance the booking confirmation screen to include comprehensive ticket information, including a reference number, which would be sent to the email that they enter in the booking form. This change would address the concern fully.

Conclusion

The LeicesterBreaks prototype successfully delivers a cohesive, user-friendly weekend city break platform for Leicester, featuring a secure login system, an eye-catching gallery, detailed attractions section with review capabilities, and a streamlined event booking system. The website effectively implemented the wireframe designs while including responsive design principles and accessibility features throughout. The Heuristic Evaluation using Nielsen's 10 usability principles provided crucial feedback on the prototype's strengths and weaknesses, while User Testing validated the core functionality with exceptional task completion rates and an impressive ease-of-use rating. To evolve LeicesterBreaks into a production-ready application, key enhancements would include implementing a backend database system, developing help documentation, adding confirmation steps, and introducing search functionality. These refinements, combined with the strong foundation already established, would make LeicesterBreaks an excellent website for tourists seeking to discover and experience the best of Leicester.